



Figure 1: App when viewed through the browser



Figure 2: App with a mobile look

HTML. Create an *index.html* file with the following contents. There is no mandatory condition that you need to name the file *index.html*. You can name it any *name.html*.

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<head>
  <title>Hello world App</title>
</head>

<body>
  <h1>Hello World</h1>
</body>
</html>
```

Now, once you go to the Firefox browser and open the *.html* file you have created, you will observe something like what's shown in Figure 1.

But, we do not have a mobile look in the browser. So press *Ctrl+Shift+M* to get a mobile look and feel. You will get something like what's shown in Figure 2.

Once you have written the *.html* file, your next step is to create the manifest file of the type *.webapp*, which contains the basic details of the app. So, let's go ahead and create this file. Given below is an example of a *manifest.webapp* file:

```
{
  "name": "My App",
  "description": "My awesome app",
  "launch_path": "index.html",
  "icons": {
    "512": "/img/icon-512.png",
    "128": "/img/icon-128.png"
  },
  "developer": {
    "name": "Your name or organization",
    "url": "http://your-homepage-here.org"
  },
  "default_locale": "en"
}
```

You need to give the name of your app and a description of it. The launch path is within the app's origin that is loaded when the app starts (the *index.html* file in this case). It is recommended that you give two images of 128x128 pixels and the other of 512x512 pixels to be used as your app's icons. Now you need to provide the developer name and URL. 'Default_locale' is the language in which the app



Figure 3: Firefox OS simulator



Figure 4: App loaded in the dashboard



Figure 5: App viewed through simulator

communicates with the user.

Once you have completed your *manifest.webapp* file, you can add your app to the Firefox simulator. Now, go on and use all your CSS and JavaScript skills to make the app even more interesting.

You can also think of adding JQuery elements to make the app more responsive and attractive.

How to use the Firefox OS simulator

Once you have installed the Firefox OS simulator, you can access it through *Tools->Web Developer->Firefox OS simulator*

You will get something like what is shown in Figure 3.

Now you need to select the 'Add Directory' option, and add the manifest file of your app. Your file gets loaded and will be visible in the dashboard (Figure 4).

The simulator starts running and you will get the app in the simulator (Figure 5).

Now, submit your app to Firefox Marketplace.

Once you complete building your app, you can upload it to Firefox Marketplace and share it with your friends, for which you need to have a Firefox account. Log in to your account, follow the instructions and upload your app to the Marketplace. Make sure you have good coding styles. The apps are tested under various conditions and are reviewed by experts. Once your app passes all the tests, it gets published in the Marketplace. **END** 

References

- [1] <https://developer.mozilla.org/en-US/Apps/BUILD>
- [2] http://shafiuil.github.io/slides/kickstart_fros.html/#/

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